Article Quality Quick Reference Example

This sample quick reference is based on Consortium for Service Innovation Member material

Knowledge Base Content Standards Quick Guide

Search early and search often before creating!

TITLE

- The customer uses the Title to decide if they will read the article or not - finalize the title last.
- Use the customer's own language to summarize the problem.
- Should be less than 200 characters for searchability
- Put the most relevant content at the beginning of the title
- If the article could apply to more than one product, place the product name at the end of the title

SYMPTOM (Required)

- Describe the issue/question in a concise and clear way using the most important details.
- Do NOT write in paragraph form – use complete thoughts, not sentences.
- Add all relevant ways customers may describe the issue.
- Include the exact error message as text so it is searchable.
- Use bullet points if there is more than one symptom listed.

ENVIRONMENT

- Capture statement describing the environment where the issue is occurring:
  - Use FULL product names – no abbreviations!
  - Use operating systems, features, functions
- Use bullet points when there is more than one item listed.

CAUSE

- If known, clearly state the underlying cause to help others understand why issues (problems) occur.
- If the cause is about a known product defect, add the appropriate bug information.

RESOLUTION (Required)

The Resolution should address the problem or answer the question posed in the Symptom.

- The Resolution section should never be empty!
- Clearly state the action(s) required to resolve the issue/question.
- If multiple steps must be followed in a specific order, use a numbered list.
- Approved workarounds can be added.

BEST PRACTICES AND TIPS

- Each article should only address ONE problem.
- Use font styles and colors with care to emphasize readability.
- Don't use language like "The customer is using", "The customer is getting", "It worked okay before". Refer to <link to knowledge article voice guidelines>
- Do not use biased and insensitive language like "whitelist / blacklist" Refer to <link to inclusive language guidelines>
- Read your article and search again before publishing, as if you were a beginner. Verify that it makes sense!

DATA PROTECTION AND SECURITY

- Screenshots from customer systems are not allowed in any Knowledge Management documentation.
- When adding screenshots/attachments from a test environment, make sure to blur or blackout the content that shows proprietary information.
- Privacy regulations apply to all articles no matter what status they are in (Work in Progress, Internal, etc.)
- Do not display/disclose Personally Identifiable Information (PII) and other confidential information, refer to <link to detailed privacy policy>.
- GDPR Disclaimer to be used ONLY if screenshots or data are from demo systems or demo data. "Image/data in this article is from internal systems, sample data, or demo systems. Any resemblance to real data is purely coincidental." Refer to <link to detailed GDPR documentation>